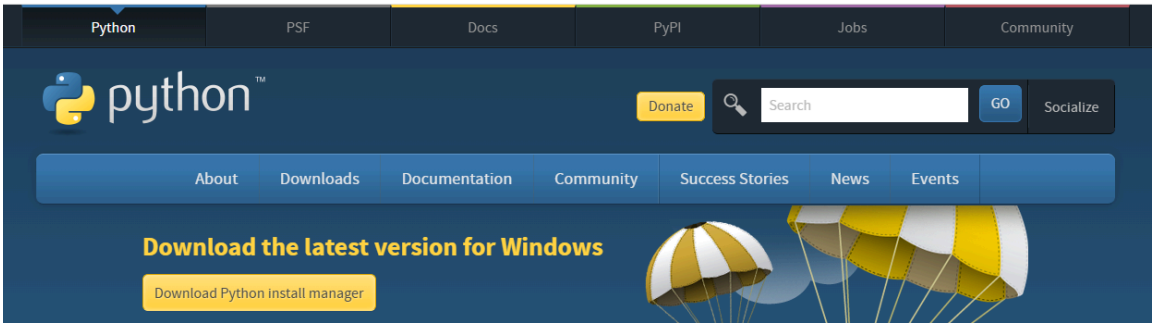
Setting Up Your Python Workspace in VS Code

Prepared by Lior Brown

Goal: Install Python and Visual Studio Code (VS Code) and create a ready-to-use Python workspace for the course.

Step 1 – Download & Install Python

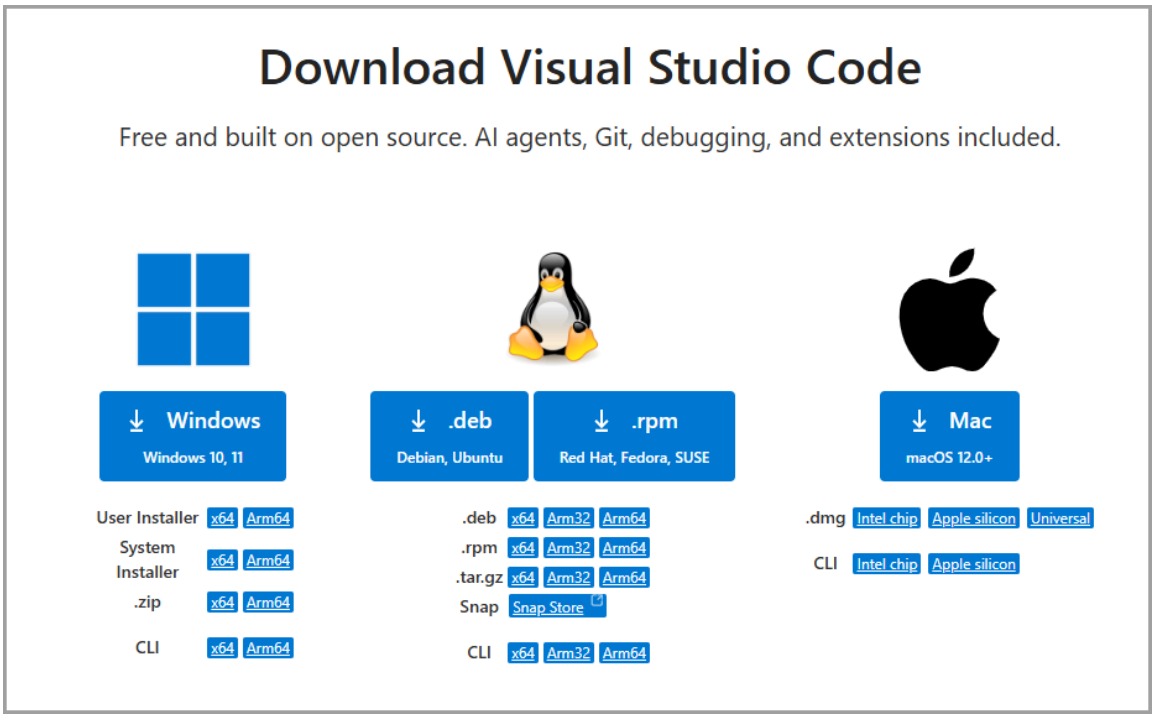
1. Go to https://www.python.org/downloads/



2. Click the yellow button to download **Python**.
3. Open the downloaded installer.
4. Before clicking **Install Now**, check the box at the very bottom that says **"Add python.exe to PATH"**.
5. Click **Install Now** and wait for it to finish.

Step 2 – Download Visual Studio Code (VS Code)

1. Visit https://code.visualstudio.com/

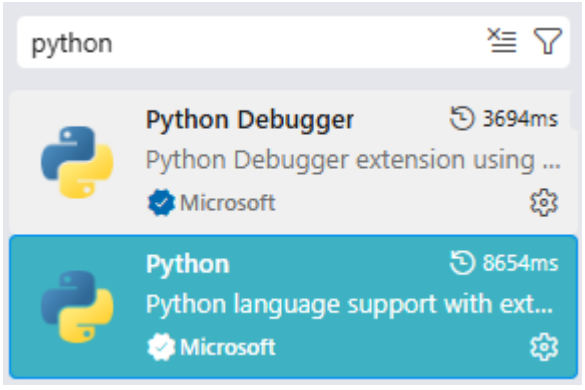


2. Select your operating system (Windows, macOS, or Linux).
3. Run the installer → default settings are fine (just keep clicking **Next**).

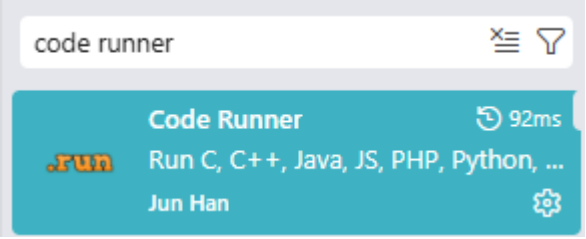
Step 3 – Install the Basic Extensions

(VS Code needs a few small add-ons to understand and run Python)

1. Open VS Code.
2. Click on the **Extensions** icon  in the far-left menu.
3. In the search bar, type **Python**.
4. Click **Install** on the one published by *Microsoft*.



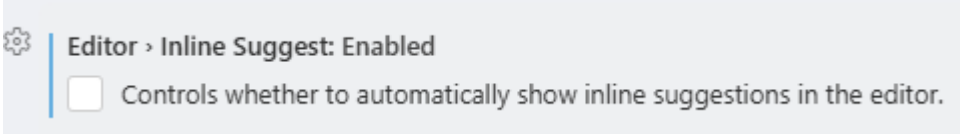
5. Next, clear the search bar and type **Code Runner**.



6. Click **Install** on the extension published by *Jun Han*.

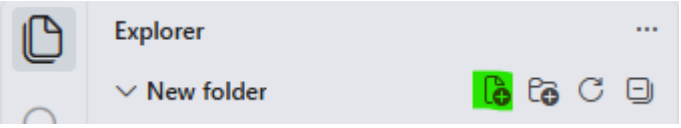
Step 4 – Disable AI Suggestions

1. Open Settings (File → Preferences → Settings, or click the Gear icon ⚙ in the bottom left).
2. In the search bar at the top, type `Inline Suggest`.
3. Uncheck the box for **Editor: Inline Suggest: Enabled**.



Step 5 – Create Your First Python Project

1. In VS Code, click **File** → **Open Folder...**
2. Create a new folder on your computer (e.g., `FirstYearPython`) and select it.
3. Hover over your folder name in the Explorer menu on the left, click the **New File** icon, and name the file `main.py`.



4. If a box pops up in the bottom-right corner asking you to select a Python interpreter, click it and select the Python version you installed in Step 1.
5. In the editor, type:

```python
print("Am Israel Chai")
```

6. Press the **Play button (▷)** in the top-right corner of the window (this uses the Code Runner extension you installed!).
7. Look at the Terminal panel at the bottom → you should see:

```text
Am Israel Chai
```

(If you don't see it, don't worry, Am Israel is still alive 🇮🇱)